

The Interamerican Series (Spanish: *Serie Interamericana*) was an international club [professional baseball tournament](#) that brought together [independent](#) and [winter league](#) teams in [North America](#), [South America](#) and the [Caribbean](#). Held from [1946](#) to [1950](#) and from [1961](#) to [1965](#), it was the precursor to the modern [Caribbean Series](#).

History

The Interamerican Series was the initiative of Venezuelan businessman Jesús Corao.^[1] It came in the wake of Venezuela hosting the [1944](#) and [1945 Amateur World Series](#), the [Serie Monumental](#) that saw American [Negro league all-stars](#) play Venezuelan clubs,^[2] and the ensuing [professionalization of the sport](#) in the country, in the form of the [Venezuelan League](#).^[3]

The inaugural series included Venezuelan champions [Cerveceria Caracas](#), [Industriales de Monterrey](#) of the [Mexican League](#),^[3] the [Havana Cubans](#) of the [Florida International League](#) (alternatively, the "All-Cubans"),^{[4][3]} and the [Brooklyn Bushwicks](#), an independent semi-pro team managed by [John Antonelli](#), with former and future [Major League](#) stars like [Tony Cuccinello](#), [Whitey Ford](#), and [Hank Borowy](#).^{[5][3]} The 1946 tournament was notable for being the place where major league scout [Joe Cambria](#) signed [Chico Carrasquel](#), then playing for Caracas.^[6] In 1947, the Bushwicks were replaced by the [Buffalo All-Stars](#), a team of [International League](#) players managed by Buffalo Bisons manager [Paul Richards](#).^{[7][8][9]} The series was suspended after 1950, as focus shifted to the [Caribbean Series](#).

The series was resurrected in 1961 as a result of the [Cuban Revolution](#); [MLB Commissioner Ford C. Frick](#) ruled that American major leaguers were barred from playing in Havana, which effectively scuttled the plans for the 1961 Caribbean Series.^[10] Instead, the new Serie Interamericana would replace the slot filled by the now-dissolved [Cuban League](#) with the champion of [Panamanian League](#), with the host nation also sending an extra team. The first edition was held in Caracas, but then shifted to San Juan and Panama City. In 1964, the champion of the [Nicaraguan League](#) became the fourth team, after Venezuela opted to instead play an interleague series against the [Dominican Republic](#).^[11]

The series struggled economically, due to the absence of Cuba as well as of the Dominican Republic, which itself was wracked in political turmoil and had been sanctioned by the [Organization of American States](#) since 1960.^[11]

Records

[No-hitters](#) (2)

- [Sandy Consuegra](#) ([All Cubans](#)) on September 22, 1949, vs [Cerveceria Caracas](#)^{[6][23]}
- [Juan Pizarro](#) ([Mayagüez](#)) on February 8, 1963, vs [Industriales de Valencia](#)^[24]

Similarly-named tournaments

Several other tournaments in the 1950s and '60s shared the "Interamerican Series" name, though historical records are spotty. A best-of-five series played in 1951 between the Sinton Plymouth Oilers, a U.S. semi-pro team from [Sinton, Texas](#), and Mexico's [Sultanes de Monterrey](#), was referred to as the Interamerican Series. This tournament was organized by the [International Baseball Congress](#), led by former MLB Commissioner [Happy Chandler](#).^[25] Another club tournament titled Pan American Series in 1958, but also referred to as the Interamerican Series, was held in Managua in 1958, between the [Venados de Mazatlán](#) of the [Mexican Pacific League](#), [Leones de León](#) of the [Nicaraguan League](#), and Vanytor de Barranquilla of the [Colombian League](#).^[26]

The Dominican Republic organized a tournament in 1965 that is sometimes referred to as the final edition of the Interamerican Series, inviting Venezuela and Puerto Rico.^[11] Major league stars like [Roberto Clemente](#) and [Felipe Alou](#) participated, but the series ended prematurely.^[11] The trophy was not formally awarded, though it is still owned by the Dominican team, [Águilas Cibaeñas](#).^[27]